

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

Road accidents and car safety

Cars have become safer as new technology, improvements to roads and better driving have reduced the number of accidents in nearly all developed countries.

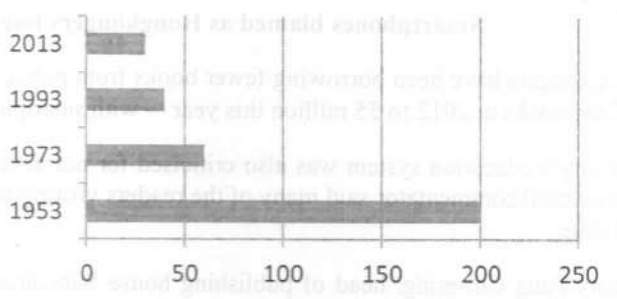
Car companies and governments have been making advances in vehicle safety.

Air-bags, cameras, radar, seat-belts, new construction materials, better road design and driver education have all been important reasons for the fall in the number of road accidents.

However, a leading road safety campaigner points out, "As car technology continues to evolve, roads are safer but we still have the problems caused by the people behind the wheel: not using seat-belts, drink-driving, driving while texting — these are problems that the best designers can't solve."

Other problems include pedestrians not following rules, poor lighting and animals running onto roads.

Road Accidents per 1,000 vehicles



The chart shows the number of road accidents has fallen rapidly in Hong Kong since 1953.

The Transport Police are visiting your school. Your group has been asked to discuss road safety in Hong Kong. You may want to talk about:

- why the number of accidents has fallen in Hong Kong
- some common causes of road accidents
- what people should do to make sure they are safe while using the road
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you think Hong Kong roads are safe?
2. Should schools teach more about road safety?
3. Should bicycles be allowed to use the same roads as cars?
4. What dangerous things do pedestrians do?
5. What can be done to help the elderly be safer when crossing roads?
6. How should we stop people crossing the road illegally?
7. Do you think most Hong Kongers follow road safety rules?
8. Would reducing the number of cars in Hong Kong make roads safer?